

STEPHANIE LI

Fullstack Engineer · React, Typescript & Next.js · Accessibility & Performance

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CORE SKILLS

Frontend: React · Next.js · TypeScript · JavaScript · Tailwind CSS · Shadcn/UI · Framer Motion · HTML · CSS

Backend & Data: Node.js · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · Supabase · REST APIs · Webhooks · Docker

ML / AI: OpenAI API · GPT-4 Prompt Engineering · Data Pipeline Design · Pandas · Regex

Testing & QA: BrowserStack · Playwright · WCAG 2.1 AA Accessibility Auditing

Languages: TypeScript · JavaScript · Python · SQL

Tools & Platforms: AWS · Vercel · Git · Stripe · Auth0 · Figma

EXPERIENCE

Full-stack Engineer · *The Investigative Journalism Foundation*

May 2024 – Aug 2026

Data-driven journalism startup · Toronto, ON

- Architected and shipped multiple award-winning investigative data products with Next.js, React, and TypeScript frontends, reaching 50,000+ monthly page views and earning national press coverage.
- Led end-to-end UX/UI redesigns of core user flows (sign-up, login, checkout), directly driving a 24% increase in user conversions.
- Independently conducted and remediated full WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility audits using BrowserStack, lifting the site accessibility score from 60 to 98, a 38% improvement.
- Engineered a custom subscription and checkout system using Stripe Elements and API, including backend endpoints for customer management, invoicing, and payment processing.
- Automated ETL data pipelines with Python, Playwright, and cURL to harvest and ingest public datasets into a PostgreSQL backend, supporting ongoing editorial investigations.
- Integrated Google Analytics Data API into frontend to track real-time insights, and identify patterns in user behaviour using Google Analytics 4 and Google Tag Manager.

Web Developer (Internship) · *TEDxToronto*

May 2022 – Sep 2022

Canada's largest TEDx community · Toronto, ON

- Shipped frontend enhancements and resolved production bugs for the TEDxToronto website using JavaScript, HTML, and CSS; deployed speaker launch pages on schedule across multiple high-visibility event announcements.
- Deployed an on-site livestream solution within 24 hours, enabling seamless speaker broadcasts ahead of event launch.
- Partnered with marketing, design, and events teams under tight production timelines to coordinate web updates, ensuring zero downtime during live speaker launches.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Appointments Database

2025

Canada's largest public database of government appointments

- Partnered with University of Toronto ML/AI researchers to iteratively prompt-engineer GPT-4 parsing logic, improving government appointment record extraction accuracy by 34% through systematic validation and QA.
- Built an end-to-end data pipeline using Python, Playwright, and OpenAI API to scrape, parse, and generate 160,000+ structured and labeled government appointment entries.
- Designed and implemented an advanced filtering, sorting, and search UI enabling exploration of 150,000+ records spanning 1990–present, with a strong emphasis on usability across a complex dataset at scale.
- Cleaned and standardized parsed data with Pandas, Regex, and SQL to address model edge cases; automated pipeline synchronization with upstream government sources.

Open-by-Default Processor

2025

Internal file processing tool for Canada's largest ATIP database

- Delivered as sole frontend engineer in under 2 months — built an internal file processing tool managing 50,000+ documents, 7M+ pages, and 1,200+ GB of PDFs released under Canada's Access to Information and Privacy (ATIP) system.
- Integrated private FastAPI endpoints for document processing and metadata management; monitored and debugged errors using AWS console and DocumentCloud.
- Significantly improved internal staff workflow efficiency, enabling the team to process and publish ATIP records at scale.

AWARDS

1st Place · UWaterloo HackRX

2022

- Designed the frontend for OptimedRX, a prescription management and patient care web app that centralizes prescription tracking, to streamline coordination between healthcare providers and patients.

2nd Place · ElleHacks

2021

- Built the UI for RBC GreenSense, an RBC Rewards mobile app that addresses wasteful consumption by promoting sustainable consumer choices using gamification and augmented-reality.

EDUCATION

McMaster University · Honours B.Sc. in Neuroscience

Sep 2019 – Dec 2023

Relevant coursework: Human Psychology · Computational Neuroscience · AI-related Cognitive Modeling

- The AI and cognitive modeling background from this degree directly informed GPT-4 prompt engineering and ML collaboration work on the Appointments Database project.